

Dr. Corey Ford

PhD QMUL, BSc(Hons) MRes UWE, PGCert UAL, AFHEA

Lecturer in Computer and Data Science

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Education and Qualifications

2020-2025	Queen Mary University of London PhD in Artificial Intelligence and Music (HCI) Thesis Title: <i>Reflection in Creativity Support Tool Interaction: Characterisations for AI-based Music Composition</i>
2019-2020	The University of the West of England MRes Data Science (HCI), Distinction
2016-2019	The University of the West of England BSc(Hons) Creative Music Technology (JAMES accredited), First class
2009-2016	Cox Green Secondary School A-Level Mathematics, Music and Media – Grade B
2005-2014	FunTech Computing School A-Level Computing (Aged 15) and GCSE ICT (Aged 12) – Grade A

Other Qualifications

2026	The University of the Arts London Pgcert Academic Practice in Art, Design and Communication
2018	The University of the West of England ILM Level 3 Mentoring Certificate

Memberships

Associate Fellow of the Higher Education Academy (AFHEA)

Student Member of the Association of Computing Machinery (ACM) & SIGCHI

Early Career Ambassador for the Computer Arts Society (CAS)

Employment

Aug 2024-present	Lecturer in Computer and Data Science (University of the Arts London) On the BSc(Hons) Computer Science and AI and Data Science degrees.
Apr-Jul 2024	Post-Doctoral Research Assistant (University of the Arts London) Worked with a London AI music start-up company to co-design interfaces for responsive generative AI. Part-time.

Summer 2023	Research Assistant (Autoethnography) (Queen Mary University of London) Conducted an in-depth autoethnographic investigation of incorporating an explainable AI plugin into my band's creative practice of composing punk rock music.
2022-2024	Teaching Fellow (Queen Mary University of London) Lecturing for User Experience Design (Level 6 & 7, 180+ students). Wrote and developed all course material for a HCI Research Methods module (Level 7). Developed course material for a GUI web development module (Level 5), walking students through Figma to HTML & CSS , to React .
2020-2023	Demonstrator (Queen Mary University of London) Assisted teaching, assessment and administration (e.g. liaison with finance) across the university's computer science and creative engineering degrees, for the following modules: • Design for Human Interaction (Level 6 and 7) • Interaction Design (Level 6 and 7) • Creative Group Project (Level 5) *winner of Sustainability Award 2023 • Arts Application Programming (Level 4)
Summer 2021	Research Assistant (Explainable AI) (Queen Mary University of London) Worked in a team to undertake a survey of AI systems which support co-creation of music between humans and machines, reviewing a number of creative AI systems from a user-centred perspective and developing a taxonomy based on how people interact with them.
2019-2021	Associate Lecturer (The University of The West of England) Contributed to lecturing, teaching, assessment (*= and curriculum design) for the BSc(Hons) Music Technology degrees and MSc Data Science degree, on the following modules: • Programming for Data Science* (Level 7) • Audio Process Design and Implementation (Level 5) • Audio Technology* (Level 4) • Introductory Audio Programming (Level 4)
2018-2020	Programming Tutor (The University of The West of England) Led drop-in sessions for students with programming questions across the university's computer science courses and their varied modules (such as: Intro to C++; Audio Process Design and Implementation; and Data Structures and Algorithms).
Summer 2019	Research Assistant (Music & Code) (The University of The West of England) Supported an iterative design process where functionality, language primitives and improved usability were developed based on my experience of transcribing music as music + code with a novel generative music programming environment, named Manhattan.
Jun-Jul 2019	Workshop Lead (The University of The West of England) Developed teaching materials and led a workshop for A-Level students, introducing them to sound editing. This was for a STEM outreach event (funded by the Institute of Coding).

Summer 2018	Audio Software Developer Intern (The University of the West of England) Worked with UWE's Creative Technologies Laboratory, supporting experimental work with their audio development board (ARM M4 & M7 chips), writing real-time C++ and FAUST code.
2017-2018	Academic PAL Leader (The University of the West of England) Mentored and facilitated learning for 1st year students in Music Technology (particularly helping with their audio programming in C++). Led to an ILM Level 3 Mentoring Award.
2017-2018	Tech Tutor (FunTech) Tutoring holiday tech camps for 8-16-year-olds. These included: Unity Game Development, Lego EV3's, Java, Python, App Design, Object-Oriented Programming & Scratch.
Mar-Apr 2017	Developer (FunTech) Wrote course content in C for a "Music Coder" tech camp. I'd pitched the idea with a mini business plan and budget estimation.
2015-2016	Network Systems Assistant (Wessex Primary School) Worked as a technician fixing general IT issues around the school.

Publications

Journal Papers

Lerch, A, Arthur, C, Bryan-Kinns, N, **Ford, C**, Sun, Q, Vinay, A (2025) Survey on the Evaluation of Generative Models in Music. ACM Computing Surveys.

Full Conference Papers

Rezwana, J and **Ford, C** (2025) Human-Centered AI Communication in Co-Creativity: An Initial Framework and Insights. ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). London, UK.

Saitis, C, Del Sette, BM, Shier, J, Tian, H, Zheng, S, Skach, S, Reed, CN, and **Ford, C** (2024) Timbre Tools: Ethnographic Perspectives on Timbre and Sonic Cultures in Hackathon Designs. ACM Audio Mostly Conference. Milan, Italy.

Bryan-Kinns, N, Noel-Hirst, A and **Ford, C** (2024) Using Incongruous Genres to Explore Music Making with AI Generated Content. ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). Chicago, USA.

Ford, C, Noel-Hirst, A, Cardinale, S, Loth, J, Sarmiento, P, Wilson, E, Wolstanholme, L, Worrall, K and Bryan-Kinns, N (2024) Reflection Across AI-based Music Composition. ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). Chicago, USA. ***Honourable Mention Award (top 5% submissions)!**

Ford, C and Bryan-Kinns, N (2023) Towards a Reflection in Creative Experience Questionnaire. ACM Conference on Computer-Human Interaction (CHI). Hamburg, Germany.

Ford, C and Bryan-Kinns, N (2022) Identifying Engagement in Children's Interaction whilst Composing Digital Music at Home. ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). Venice, Italy.

Ford, C, Bryan-Kinns, N and Nash, C (2021) Creativity in Children's Digital Music Composition. International Conference on New Interfaces for Musical Expression (NIME). NYU Shanghai, China.

Ford, C and Nash, C (2020) An Iterative Design by 'Proxy' Method for Developing Educational Music Interfaces. International Conference on New Interfaces for Musical Expression (NIME). Birmingham, UK.

Book Chapters

Bryan-Kinns, N, Banar, B **Ford, C**, Reed, CN, Yixiao, Z and Armitage, J (2024) Explainable AI and Music. Artificial Intelligence for Art Creation and Understanding. CRC Press.

Workshop Proposals and Proceedings

Ford, C, Sutskova, O, Rhys Cox, S, Sterman, S, Kreminski, M, Van Koningsbruggen, R, Wang, A, Otenen, E, Ross, K, Di Fede, G, Li, Y, Andolina, S, Bentvelzen, M, Hui, P, Bryan-Kinns, N (2026) The First Reflection in Creative Experience (RiCE) Workshop. ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). London, UK.

Sun, J, Di Maggio, F, Fiebrink, R, **Ford, C**, Hengeveld, B and Deterding, S (2026) What Makes it Fun? Mapping Playful Interaction in Music-Making with AI. International Conference on New Interfaces for Musical Expression (NIME). London, UK.

Zheng, S, Broad, T, Wilson, E, Cole, A, Xu, Z, Chang, J, Vigliensoni, G, Rezwana, J, Xiao, L, Clemens, M, Lewis, M, Chamberlain, A, Kennedy, H, **Ford, C** and Bryan-Kinns, N (2026) Explainable AI for the Arts 4 (XAIxArts4). ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). London, UK.

Ford, C, Wilson, E, Zheng, S, Vigliensoni, G, Rezwana, J, Xiao, L, Clemens, M, Lewis, M, Hemment, D, Chamberlain, A and Kennedy, H (2025) Proceedings of The third international workshop on eXplainable AI for the Arts (XAIxArts). arXiv.

Ford, C, Wilson, E, Zheng, S, Vigliensoni, G, Rezwana, J, Xiao, L, Clemens, M, Lewis, M, Hemment, D, Chamberlain, A, Kennedy, H, and Bryan-Kinns, N (2025) Explainable AI for the Arts 3 (XAIxArts3). ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). London, UK.

Bryan-Kinns, N, **Ford, C**, Zheng, S, Kennedy, H, Chamberlain, A, Lewis, M, Hemment, D, Li, Z, Wu, Q, Xiao, L and Xia, G (2024) Proceedings of The second international workshop on eXplainable AI for the Arts (XAIxArts). arXiv.

Bryan-Kinns, N, **Ford, C**, Zheng, S, Kennedy, H, Chamberlain, A, Lewis, M, Hemment, D, Li, Z, Wu, Q, Xiao, L, Xia, G, Rezwana, J, Clemens, M, and Vigliensoni, G. (2024) Explainable AI for the Arts 2 (XAIxArts2). ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). Chicago, USA.

Bryan-Kinns, N, **Ford, C**, Chamberlain, A, Benford, S, Kennedy, H, Li, Z, Qiong, W, Xia, G and Rezwana, J. (2023) Proceedings of The first international workshop on eXplainable AI for the Arts (XAIxArts). arXiv.

Bryan-Kinns, N, **Ford, C**, Chamberlain, A, Benford, S, Kennedy, H, Li, Z, Qiong, W, Xia, G and Rezwana, J (2023) Explainable AI for the Arts: XAIxArts. ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). Online.

Short Papers and Extended Abstracts

Xie, M and **Ford, C** (2026) Painting, Programming, and Process: Comparing Observational Painting and Object-Oriented Programming (OOP). Electronic Visualisation and the Arts (EVA) London. London, UK.

Sharma, A, Rodic, A, Saleem, S, Sourie, M and **Ford, C** (2025) Decolonizing Computer Science: Holograms in Holborn. ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). London, UK.

Joshi, N, Bagga, R, Clayton, R, Adan, M, Kalule, J and **Ford, C** (2025) Decolonizing Computer Science: The Immersive Elevator Experience. ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). London, UK.

Rezwana, J and **Ford, C** (2025) Improving User Experience with FAICO: Towards a Framework for AI Communication in Human-AI Co-Creativity. Proceedings of the Extended Abstracts of the Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI). Yokohama, Japan.

Saitis, C, Del Sette, BM, Tian, H, Shier, J, Zheng, S, Skach, S, Reed, CN, and **Ford, C** (2024) Ethnographic Exploration of Timbre in Hackathon Designs. CHIME Annual Workshop, Milton Keynes, UK.

Lewis, M... **Ford, C** and 38 others (2024) Travelling Arts x HCI Sketchbook: Exploring the Intersection Between Artistic Expression and Human-Computer Interaction. alt.chi at CHI. Hawaii, USA.

Ford, C, Cardinale, S and Bryan-Kinns, N (2023) Three Open Questions for the Design of AI for Music Composition. CHIME One Day Workshop, Milton Keynes, UK.

Ford, C and Bryan-Kinns, N (2023) On the Role of Reflection and Digital Tool Design for Creative Practitioners. Workshop on Digital Skills for the Creative Practitioner: Supporting Informal Learning of Technologies for Creativity at CHI. Hamburg, Germany.

Ford, C and Bryan-Kinns, N (2022) Speculating on Reflection and People's Music Co-Creation with AI. Workshop on Generative AI and HCI at ACM CHI. New Orleans, USA.

Bryan-Kinns, N, Banar, B, **Ford, C**, Reed, CN, Zhang, Y, Colton, S and Armitage, J (2021) Exploring XAI for the Arts: Explaining Latent Space in Generative Music. 1st Workshop on eXplainable AI Approaches for Debugging and Diagnosis at NeurIPS. New Orleans, USA.

Supervision

PhD Students (Supervision Team)

2026 Li Lin
Thesis Topic: *Accessibility and Video Games*

MSc Students

2026 Reiner Rillo (AI Music); Giacomo Uliassi (AI Plant Aggregation)

2021 Supported supervision of 2 MSc Computing and Information Systems (Conversion) Dissertations at Queen Mary University of London

Undergrad Students

2026

Anika Ojha (); Aya Jebari (); Belle Williams (AI Pose Detection for Fitness); Tharshan Jeevamanokar (); Yu Lim (AI Music Making)

Reviewing

Member of the **ACM TOCHI** Distinguished Reviewer Board

ACM CHI (Full papers; Extended abstracts; alt.chi); **ACM DIS** (ACM Research-Through-Design Committee; Full Papers); **ACM C&C** (Full papers; Pictorials; Artworks; Demos); **Computer Music Journal**; **Personal and Ubiquitous Computing Journal**; **ACM Multimedia** (Artworks); **NIME** (Full papers, alt.nime jury); **International Workshop on Haptic & Audio Interaction Design** (HAID); **Explainable AI for the Arts Workshop** (XAIxArts); **Digital Music Research Network Workshop** (DMRN).

Technical Skills

Research

UX – User studies, personas, usability testing, user stories, card sorting, wizard-of-oz, ideation, design fiction, prototyping & wireframing, child-computer interaction

Knowledge – Designing for engagement, designing for reflection, creativity support tools, human-AI interaction, Norman's design principles, ethnography, autoethnography, design justice, NIME

Quantitative Methods – machine learning, experiment design and analysis; A/B testing; questionnaire development and validation; structural equation modelling; factor analysis; interaction logs; data mining

Qualitative Methods – think-aloud studies; interviews; video-cued recall; thematic analysis, discourse analysis

Languages

JavaScript (audio, GUI, ML); **C++** (interactive systems and embedded); **Python** (data mining, statistics, ML); **LaTeX** (publications); **R** (statistics); **Java**; **HTML**; **CSS**;

Frameworks

JUCE (large-scale multi-threaded applications); **Processing & P5js** (musical interfaces, generative art, web ML); **Web** (React, Tone.js, NPM); **OpenFrameworks** (interactive systems, generative art); **Machine Learning** (TensorFlow, Keras); **Anaconda** (numpy, pandas, matplotlib)

Tools

GIT; **MIDI**; **BibTex**; **Doxygen**; **UML**; **JSON**; **XML**

IoT

Arduino; **Raspberry Pi**; **ESP32**; **MQTT**

Music

Sibelius, **Logic**, **Pro Tools**, **Cubase & Reaper**

Guitar (grade 8 standard); **Piano** (self-taught); **Music Composition** (portfolio on request)

Other OS (Mac OSX, Windows, Linux); **Applications** (Xcode, Visual Studio, Adobe Creative Suite, MS Office); **Driving** (British driving license)

Organisation & Professional Service

Conference Organisation

2025-2026	Posters and Demos Chair for ACM Creativity and Cognition (C&C)
2023-2024	Student Volunteer Chair for ACM Creativity and Cognition (C&C)
2023-2024	Session Chairs for ACM Creativity and Cognition (C&C)
2021	Programme chair & editor for Digital Music Research Network One-Day Workshop

Workshop Volunteering

2020	Workshop support for the BBC Digital Cities Event with Manhattan at the Engine Shed, Bristol
2020	Workshop support for “Crowd Driven Music with Manhattan” at the NIME Conference

Ethics Panels

2025-present	Creative Computing Institute Research Committee Member (University of the Arts London)
2023-2024	Queen Mary Ethics of Research Committee Member (Devolved School Ethics Committee)

Other

2025-present	Co-organiser of ACM Student Chapter for the Creative Computing Institute at University of the Arts London
2021	Organiser for group lab event between the IRCAM ACIDS lab (France) and the AI + Music CDT (UK)
2020	Student Representative for the AI + Music CDT (Queen Mary University of London)
2019	Student Representative for the MRes Data Science Degree (University of the West of England)

Invited Talks

Phenomenology Guest Lecture at Queen Mary University of London (2026)

EVA and CAS Student Mentoring at the Electronic Visual Arts Conference (2025)

Creativity & Design Guest Lecture at Queen Mary University of London (2025)

From Code to Chord: Live AI Music at the Music Managers Forum Summit on AI (2023)

ART-ificial Intelligence and Music at the Pint of Science Festival (2022)

On Creativity & Codetta for the School of Computing and Communications at the Open University (2021)

Codetta Talk & Workshop for MA Creative Music Practice students at the University of Gloucestershire (2020)

Awards

Nominated for an Arts Students' Union Award for Outstanding Teaching (2026)

Honourable Mention Award (top 5% submissions) for "Reflection Across AI-based Music Composition" at ACM Creativity & Cognition 2024

Pendlebury-Tucker Prize (Award for Best Music Technology Project) (£200)

Dean's Award for Academic Excellence 2016/2017 and 2017/2018

Granted funding from the University of the West of England's enterprise summer scholarship scheme (£1000)

References

References available on request.